

STORYBOARD

Tailgate Talk 2.0: Preparing Road Crews for Technology-Assisted Drivers

Prepared by Jordan Smith | Companion to the Needs Analysis—see that document for objectives, audience, and rationale | September 2026

Course Structure Overview

Lesson	Purpose	Est. runtime
1. Why the Tailgate Talk Is Changing	Establish the strategic/regulatory context and the two new hazard categories	~3–4 min
2. Running an Updated Briefing	Video framing → branching scenario practice → knowledge check → job aid	~7–8 min

1. Lesson: Why the Tailgate Talk Is Changing

#	Rise block type	On-screen content	Notes
1.1	Lesson header (auto)	Lesson 1: Why the Tailgate Talk Is Changing	Default Rise cover
1.2	Statement	“Every job starts the same way: a tailgate talk. Hazards. Protective measures. Roles. But the road you’re briefing for today isn’t the road you trained on.”	Full-bleed statement block; sets the hook. Narrate with recorded (or Rise text-to-speech) audio
1.3	Text	“Vehicles on Ottawa’s roads—like vehicles across North America—increasingly come equipped with adaptive cruise control, lane-keeping assist, and automatic emergency braking. At the same time, more drivers rely on real-time navigation apps to route around closures, rather than watching the road directly. Both trends are good news for road safety overall. They also introduce a hazard your tailgate talk needs to catch.”	Plain paragraph block; narrate with audio
1.4	Labeled graphic (2 markers)	Marker 1: “Could this vehicle’s own systems—not its driver—decide whether it actually slows down for our closure?” (driver-assist technology) · Marker 2: “Does this closure show up yet in a driver’s navigation app, or could it still route traffic straight through?” (Real-time closure reporting)	Use a simple work-zone/cone-and-signage stock image as the base graphic; narrate each marker with audio
1.5	Quote	“Ambiguity is what turns a routine job into a fatality. The buffer you set up is only as good as the assumptions you made about who—or what—is driving toward it.”	Reinforces stakes before moving on. Attribute to a named safety-persona avatar (e.g. “Site Safety Sarah”) for

			institutional voice.
1.6	Continue	Continue to Lesson 2	Standard Rise continue button

2. Activity: Running an Updated Briefing

#	Rise block type	On-screen content	Notes
2.1	Text	Recap: a standard tailgate talk covers hazards, protective measures, and roles. This lesson adds a fourth checkpoint—see it in action below.	Short orientation paragraph; narrate with audio
2.2	Video	Jordan's recorded intro (see Video Script below)	Embed via URL (unlisted YouTube/Vimeo), not direct upload
2.3	Scenario	Branching tailgate-talk simulation (see Scenario Script below)	Rise Scenario block—dialogue content, up to 3 responses per turn
2.4	Knowledge check	1–2 questions (see Knowledge Check below)	Multiple choice / true-false; illustrate each question with a relevant photo
2.5	Button	"Download the Tailgate Talk 2.0 job aid"	Link to the hosted PDF
2.6	Statement	"The road is changing faster than habits do. One more question in the briefing is a small cost for closing that gap. BOTTOM LINE: In every tailgate talk, consider what could bring a vehicle into this space other than a fully attentive human driver."	Closing line, with a bolded one-line takeaway added at the end

Video Script—Block 2.2 (~60–90 seconds)

"Hi, I'm Jordan, and I'll be walking you through today's briefing. Here's the situation: your crew's been dispatched to a routine pothole patch on a residential arterial. Nothing about the work order looks unusual. But before anyone sets a cone, you need to run the tailgate talk—and this stretch of road has two things worth flagging: it's a corridor where a lot of newer vehicles run adaptive cruise control and lane-keep assist, and the closure was only just set up, so it may not show up yet in navigation apps. Neither of those facts is on the work order. Finding them is your job, and it starts with the questions you ask in this tailgate talk. Ready? Let's run it."

Production notes:

- Landscape orientation, plain or blurred background, good front lighting—a simple webcam take is fine.
- One continuous take at a natural pace; a script this short doesn't need to be memorized word-for-word, close paraphrase is fine as long as the two flagged facts (driver-assist corridor, unreported closure) land clearly.
- Keep it under 90 seconds—this is the framing beat, not the lesson itself.

Scenario Script—Block 2.3

Rise 360's Scenario block structures content as scenes made of dialogue turns; each turn offers up to three responses, each with its own feedback and "Go to" destination. Structure below.

Scene	Character line	Learner response option	Feedback	Go to
A— Opening	Crew Lead: "Okay team, quick job—patch a pothole on Bank Street just north of Sunnyside. Should take fifteen minutes. Let's do the tailgate talk and get moving."	R1 (best): "Before we do—has the closure been reported so it shows up for GPS and navigation apps, and is there anything about this stretch we should know, like a lot of vehicles running adaptive cruise control or lane-keep assist?"	"Good catch. Confirming the closure is reported AND asking about driver-assist patterns on this stretch up front is exactly right."	Scene B
A— Opening	(same)	R2 (incomplete): "Sure, let's just get the cones and signs out and get started."	"That's a good habit, but it's not enough anymore—cones and signage confirm your setup is compliant, not whether every approaching vehicle will actually recognize and respond to it. Try again."	Retry Scene A
A— Opening	(same)	R3 (weak): "Fifteen minutes, easy—let's just get moving, we can wave people through if something looks off."	"This is exactly the kind of ambiguity that leads to serious incidents. Let's look at what could go wrong."	Scene C
B— Follow-up	Crew Lead: "Good question—yes, this stretch of Bank Street doesn't show the closure in most navigation apps yet since we just set it up, and Dispatchh has flagged it as a corridor where a lot of newer vehicles run adaptive cruise control and lane-keep assist."	R1 (best): "Then we should assume some approaching vehicles won't slow down on their own until a driver actively steps in—let's add advance warning signage and a second Traffic Control Person further back, not just rely on the cones and one flagger."	"Exactly. Extra advance warning and a second TCP account for the vehicle that isn't fully in a driver's hands yet—not just the driver who's paying full attention."	Scene D (success ending)
B— Follow-up	(same)	R2 (incomplete): "As long as we're wearing our high-visibility gear, we're fine."	"Not quite—high-vis helps a human driver see you, but it doesn't address a vehicle whose automation hasn't picked up on the closure or slowed down yet. Think about what else could put a vehicle in this space unexpectedly."	Retry Scene B
C—Near miss	Narration (text card, no character): "Ten minutes into the job, a sedan running adaptive cruise control approaches the single-lane closure and doesn't	Continue	—	Back to Scene A

	begin slowing until the driver brakes manually at the last second, well inside the buffer zone. No one is hurt this time—but only because of timing.”			
D— Success ending	Crew Lead: “Confirmed—the closure’s reported through the City’s system, we’ve got advance signage and a second TCP posted back from the taper, and everyone’s briefed that not every vehicle will start slowing on its own. We’re clear to proceed.”	Continue	—	End Scenario → Block 2.4

Knowledge Check—Block 2.4

Q1 (multiple choice, illustrated with a photo evocative of the safety stakes, e.g. an emergency-response vehicle): “Which of the following is a NEW hazard category that growing vehicle automation adds to a standard work-zone tailgate talk?”

- A) Weather conditions
- B) Vehicles under partial automation (adaptive cruise control, lane-keep assist) that may not reliably recognize temporary traffic control—CORRECT
- C) PPE availability
- D) Materials and equipment shortages

Correct feedback: “Right—a vehicle’s own systems, not just its driver, increasingly help decide whether it actually slows for a work zone, which is exactly what the updated briefing question is designed to catch.”

Q2 (true/false, illustrated with a photo evocative of driver-assist technology, e.g. a dashboard display showing adaptive cruise control engaged): “Wearing high-visibility apparel and setting out standard cones and signage is enough to confirm that every approaching vehicle will recognize and stop for a work zone.”

Answer: False. Feedback: “High-visibility apparel and standard signage are still essential, but they assume a human driver is fully watching and in control—they don’t address a vehicle whose adaptive cruise control or lane-keep assist hasn’t been triggered to slow down yet, or a closure that isn’t yet reflected in a driver’s navigation app. That’s exactly why Tailgate Talk 2.0 adds a dedicated question.”

Job Aid Content Outline—Block 2.5

Delivered as a separate one-page PDF (Jordan Smith - Job Aid - Tailgate Talk 2.pdf). Content:

- Title: “Tailgate Talk 2.0” with the “Ambiguity = Fatality” line carried over from standard practice.
- Steps 1–4: the unchanged core (traffic control plan/closure confirmation, hazards, protective measures, roles), as brief prompts.
- Step 5, visually flagged as NEW: two checkbox questions covering real-time closure reporting and driver-assist-heavy corridors, each with the specific confirmation required (closure reported; advance warning/second TCP added).
- Footer: general reference to OHSA and Ontario Traffic Manual Book 7; designer credit.

Build Notes

- Narrate every Statement/Text/Labeled Graphic block with recorded (or Rise text-to-speech) audio, not just the Lesson 2 video.
- Insert an extra explicit checklist recap directly into Lesson 1, right before the closing quote: restate the two Step 5 driver-assist questions as checkbox-style bullets, plus the bolded “if uncertain, treat as unpredictable” caution line—reinforcing the new checkpoint in the lesson itself, not only in the separate job aid.
- Attribute the closing Lesson 1 quote (block 1.5) to a named safety-persona avatar (e.g., “Site Safety Sarah”) rather than leaving it unattributed—gives the module a bit more institutional voice.
- Illustrate each Knowledge Check question with a relevant photo rather than leaving it as plain text (see the Notes column above for suggested images).
- Add one more short Statement block at the very end of Lesson 2, in Jordan's own voice, restating the proof-of-concept/portfolio-piece framing directly inside the live module (not just in the supporting documents)—useful context for anyone previewing it live.